

tions. For example, spice is a valuable resource, but only some will go to great lengths in order to gain ultimate control over the spice trade. Perhaps they have made huge sacrifices along the way in order to gain the control that they have now. Maybe these sacrifices have shaped the way the villain looks at the world or how they react to others around them. While these can make for interesting plot devices, be sure to take a step back and look at how some of the hooks can impact the players' well-being.

Think of the villain as someone who has deep and intense motivations, but do not define their villainy through their gender, sexuality, race, or disability. This paints a picture of a more three-dimensional villain whose goals exceed those of everyone around them, while keeping in mind the safety measures.

Even though you, as the GM, might have control over the story framework, there will be times when players would rather go in one direction instead of another. Playing with a villain is no different, especially when you have an idea of a scary antagonist carved out in your mind, only to find that the players would rather have a cartoonish supervillain. Even after agreeing on the tone of the game beforehand, you might have an idea of what the villain would do to place the player characters in danger or threaten the people around them. Sometimes this could cross over to very real situations and behavior that can hurt the players, damage the story, and essentially break the game.

Listen to the players and ask them questions, before jumping into something that could potentially harm them, especially when it comes to topics such as violence. If you are not sure where to start, before the game begins ask the players a few questions:

- ❖ "What are some lines that we would like to draw when it comes to the villain? These will be lines that we do not cross and we will not bring up these topics in play."
- ❖ "Is there anything you would like to see, but you do not want to go into detail? For example, action movie violence would be okay in the game, but let's not go into every detail about every punch the villain throws, because then we would be playing for another three hours."
- ❖ "What do you think your character would hate to see, but you as a player, would love to see? Maybe your character has a fear of insects, but you as a player would love to see a villain with an affinity towards insects."
- ❖ Use what the players tell you as inspiration for how you will shape the villain and the obstacles that you will throw at the player characters.

Setting expectations is a great way to start the game, so players know what to expect and both you and the players would know how to maneuver around certain

plot points. In other words, be sure to pre-negotiate before the villain plans on doing something extremely catastrophic to any of the characters, non-player characters included. If this is something that could be a huge reveal leading up to a cliffhanger, you can always re-write the scene or adjust it according to what you and the players want. Remember that the story that you are creating is a story that is being created together. You might be directing the scenes, but the players are lead actors, writers, and producers, so make sure they have some agency as well, especially in scenes with the villain. Some questions that you might ask that grant the players agency in telling the story are:

- ❖ "Why does the villain despise your character?"
- ❖ "What does the villain do that makes your character nervous or scared?"
- ❖ "At what point does your character realize that the villain is ready to do whatever it takes to achieve their goals?"
- ❖ "What is the villain doing that causes your character to fight back or flee?"
- ❖ "How does your character know that the villain is close to wreaking devastation across the world? To what lengths will your character go to make sure they do not carry out their plans?"

Make sure that you use safety tools (outlined in **Chapter 8: Gamemastering**), if things get too intense at the table and course correct as needed. Set the expectation that they will be available, so that everyone is comfortable using them. These safety tools are not for players to police one another's behavior, but they are there for everyone to make room for a more engaging story. Constraints provide room for more creativity, allowing you and the players to come up with more interesting solutions and plots.

Being mindful of everyone in the room is hard work, but it is a skill that you can develop and hone over time. Just remember that if you do make a mistake, be gentle with yourself. Thank the player that pointed it out, rewind, and re-do the scene. The same goes for other players at the table. If you note something that someone else did that makes you feel uncomfortable, it's okay to let them know. No one is perfect, not even the writers of this book!

BREATHING LIFE INTO MINOR NPCs

When we talk about non-player characters that are ordinary folk, we are talking about the barkeepers or the market traders who will likely remain at the location where the player characters found work, before going home at night after a hard day's work. They are mostly neutral and can help the player characters, instead of attempting to create obstacles for them. They probably

will not go on adventures with the player characters. Instead, they might help them with clues, dropping hints of information, leading the player characters on to their larger adventures.

Though it might not seem like they are too important, they oftentimes actually serve as an introductory point for the player characters. They are also great sources of information and can give players insight on the ins and outs of the planet they are on. When these non-player characters are introduced as the first point of contact that the player characters will have, they can act as a hook for the players to stay engaged. Introducing interesting characters with engaging information can lead to many interesting avenues for gameplay later. You can draw your players into the game with these non-player characters in many ways, such as by asking yourself these questions:

- What are some defining characteristics about the non-player character's personality? Are they boisterous and welcoming, or do they always carry a look of exasperation?
- How does the character react to conflict? If they're a barkeep, maybe they've seen one too many fights happen at the tavern, so instead of reacting with shock, they might be annoyed or apathetic when they see a fight break out.
- How much does the character know? Do they have some secrets that they would like to divulge to the player characters? Do they have any leads to adventures that the player characters might be interested in?

Using the market trader as an example, just because they spend most of their days selling their wares, this does not mean that they don't see a lot of action happening in the marketplace or have insight toward the politics that are happening on the planet that they live on. Maybe they are familiar with all the gossip that spreads between traders. This could be things that they have heard from their customers, whether they are traveling as tourists or are locals with political power. Or maybe their distribution networks have been cut because of a catastrophic event and they have opinions on how the current governing body is dealing with that event.

They have probably seen many different people go through the marketplace, so they are used to constant interaction, maintaining a positive façade so customers will make a purchase. If you have ever worked at a retail shop, you probably know how draining that can be! If and when a fight breaks out, they might be annoyed. Their merchandise could be ruined at any moment, like many times in the past! Maybe that is when the player characters catch glimpses of the non-player character showing their true self, when they are placed in a moment of high stress. They are no longer that efficient salesperson that the player characters saw earlier, but a tired parent who is trying to make ends meet in an oppressive society. Introducing moments like these create empathy for the non-player characters, making them feel more real, while also giving you the opportunity to reveal secrets and hints about the world that the characters are playing in.



ARCHETYPES



he archetypes that are provided in this game are **notable** supporting characters that you can use to introduce your players to the world that you create (as opposed to more general **minor** supporting characters or **major** NPCs such as for the canon characters). They will probably spend quite some time with the player characters, pushing them along with the story. Even though these archetypes have been pre-generated, it is encouraged that you still spend some time putting yourself into their shoes by asking yourself questions.

If you are planning to spend a bit more time on expanding on these supporting characters, after reading through their traits, drives, skills, focuses, talents, and assets, consider the supporting characters' internalized thoughts for each of these. For example, if we were to look at a Sardaukar who has the Military Officer trait, ask whether they enjoy command over others. Do they enjoy having that authority or would they prefer doing something else? One way of doing this is by adding statements to each point that would give you a better understanding of the archetype's thoughts and feelings. Ask yourself questions such as:

- ❖ Has this archetype ever felt the sting of failure? If so, how did they react?
- ❖ What would they do if given a difficult choice or if they are put under a lot of pressure? Would they act instinctively or think before acting out?
- ❖ Did they always want to be in this job or did they have dreams of doing something else?

Continuing with our Sardaukar Military Officer example, under Traits, you could have: "I'm not sure if I'm fit for this job. I know others see me as competent, but I'm not sure of myself sometimes." This could give you some insight into how the archetype feels about themselves in their position and how they could choose to relay plot information to the players when you roleplay as them.

For drives, write down something that summarizes the other statements related to their drives. Maybe it's something like "I have a duty to my people, but I don't believe the House rulers have our best interests at heart." Perhaps there was a time when the archetype noticed something wrong with the House rulers and have been suspicious ever since. That could be shown through how willing they are to divulge secret information to the player characters. Maybe they have a stronger sense of community that goes beyond their job.

Continuing with skills, how do they feel about their set of skills? Do they feel like they are an expert, or do they downplay what they know? Find the one that they are strongest at and write a brief statement on how the archetype uses this skill. For example, if they play the baliset, a statement could be: "I'm well-trained in the instrument, but I only play around my closest friends." If they become closer to the player characters, they might surprise them with a song, showing their affection for their new friends.

What is the archetype's talent? Perhaps it's Improvised Weapon, which means at some point, they must have used this talent in the past. When they did, what did it look like? How were they able to defend themselves with a makeshift weapon? Through answering these questions, you can come up with a short bit of background through your statement that might sound something like: "The last time I had to fight a smuggler, I used the closest thing I could find — a vase from the poor market trader's stall! I paid them back for the damages, of course."

And finally, write a brief sentence or two for each of their assets and how the archetype feels about them. Some questions you might ask yourself about human assets are:

- ❖ Does the archetype trust them? Are they longtime friends or work acquaintances?
- ❖ How does the archetype treat the asset? Do they have inside jokes or petty slights that the player characters might notice?
- ❖ Why would this asset be important for the archetype and the player characters? Do they sell water to the archetype? Maybe they have an emotional attachment?

Again, these exercises of writing down brief statements are optional, but it should help you process the characters' personalities and motivations, so that you can better portray them in the game. And of course, you are welcome to adjust these archetypes if you would rather see them take on new skills or talents. Maybe you would like the Bene Gesserit Agent to understand geology instead of psychiatry, and that is absolutely okay if you think that fits better with your game.

When introducing these archetypes, think about how they would benefit the player characters. Maybe they have an adventure for the player characters, or maybe they were assigned to help them, or maybe they are just interested in tagging along somehow. Whatever the motivation is, keep the players engaged to find out more, while still maintaining a supporting role. Some ways that an archetype can help connect the dots for players are:

- ❖ Taking the player characters to meet with one of their assets so that they can find out more about the adventure and advance in the task at hand.
- ❖ Using the archetype to introduce other non-player characters, so player characters can note the interpersonal dynamics of the different societies that reside in the Imperium and speak with other personalities.
- ❖ Letting the archetype set up obstacles, leaving it up to the player characters use their skills to overcome the problem.
- ❖ Use the archetype as a messenger when you want to drop in various plot points. Maybe they overheard soldiers talking at the tavern or they find an important message in the sand.

When playing with the archetypes, let them give the player characters chances to succeed, and remember that they are there to give the players new ideas to explore the game and come to their own conclusions. You can use them to try and help the player characters whenever players feel stuck, but they are ultimately there to provide guidance. The spotlight should mostly be on the player characters.

ARRAKEEN NATIVE

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY: **6** Hard work and talent lead to advancement.

FAITH: **5**

JUSTICE: **4**

POWER: **4**

TRUTH: **4**

☞ **Renki** is a plumber who knows more about water than the Fremen think he should. He has a large family to support.

☞ **Gral** is a cobbler who has a stall in the market. Everyone needs shoes and Gral seems to know something about everybody.

SCENARIO HOOK

An artisan working for the player characters' House has valuable information that could harm a rival. In exchange for this, she asks for permanent employment. Background checks reveal she was formerly employed by that same rival House. Why is she no longer working for them? Could this be an opportunity to plant false information?

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE: **3**

COMMUNICATE: **4**

DISCIPLINE: **6** Composure, Precision

MOVE: **4**

UNDERSTAND: **5** Advanced Technology

Traits: Commoner

TALENTS

☞ **Cool Under Pressure (Discipline):** May spend Determination to automatically succeed at a Discipline skill test.

Assets: Tools of Trade, Workshop

The native population of Arrakeen—its 'pyons' as designated within the *Faufreluches*—make their livings in a variety of ways not intimately connected to Noble Houses or organized crime. Many are artisans, skilled in a particular trade, and nobles sometimes call on them to carry out specialized work beyond the ability of their servants. Some hope to impress and become permanent staff. Others gather information, hoping to sell it to the highest bidder.

EXAMPLE ARRAKEEN NATIVES

☞ **Elna** creates murals for pay. Devoted to her art, she keeps an ear out for saleable information.



ASSASSIN

DRIVE STATEMENT

DUTY:

6

FAITH:

4

JUSTICE:

4

POWER:

7

Death determines who rules.

TRUTH:

4

SKILL FOCUSES

BATTLE:

7

Assassination,
Sneak Attacks

COMMUNICATE:

4

DISCIPLINE:

5

MOVE:

6

Stealth

UNDERSTAND:

4

Traits: Assassin, Advisor to a Great House

TALENTS

- ☞ **Master-at-Arms:** At the start of a duel, skirmish, or battle, they may spend 1 point of Threat to increase a martial asset they have by +1 Quality for that conflict.

Assets: Dartgun, Hunter-seeker, Poison

In the Imperium, assassins are sanctioned professionals. As strange as it may be, these killers are as much a part of the fabric of the Imperium as the Emperor himself. They tip the balance of power by removing their employers' political competitors, economic rivals, or social adversaries, all while following the Great Convention's rules and the guidelines in the Assassins' Handbook, of course.

Assassins of the Imperium often employ poisons and hunter-seekers to minimize collateral damage, as per the regulations put on a War of Assassins. However, they train in a variety of martial arts and can also kill by combat and direct means, when necessary.

When they are not on a mission of murder, assassins often double as advisors to their Houses, and as a result, they have a deep understanding of the inner workings of the Landsraad. It is not unusual for these professional killers to have influence and titles of their own.

EXAMPLE ASSASSINS

- ☞ **Alcott** is occasionally tasked with murdering a competitor to their House Minor. However, they spend most of their time training the young heirs of their employer to avoid assassins.
- ☞ **Ratna** is a sharpshooter and specializes in long-distance assassinations for her House. She is most known for her ability to find and neutralize other assassins.
- ☞ **Fraze** has no loyalty to any particular House. He works as a freelancer and will kill anyone for enough solaris. His knife skills have toppled more than one member of the Landsraad.

SCENARIO HOOK

After disappearing, an assassin is on the run from their former employer. They have a lot of valuable secrets and will pay someone to help keep them safe. Several influential Houses want this assassin alive. Even more want them dead.

BENE GESSERIT AGENT

DRIVE STATEMENT

DUTY: **7** I know my responsibilities.

FAITH: **6**

JUSTICE: **5**

POWER: **5**

TRUTH: **5**

SKILL FOCUSES

BATTLE: **5**

COMMUNICATE: **4**

DISCIPLINE: **7** Composure, Espionage

MOVE: **6** Body Control

UNDERSTAND: **5**

Traits: Bene Gesserit

TALENTS

- ☉ **Prana-Bindu Conditioning:** May re-roll 1d20 on a Move or Discipline test.
- ☉ **Hyperawareness:** Whenever she spends Threat to Obtain Information, she may know two pieces of hidden information for each point spent. Further, the limits of what others would be able to notice does not apply to her.

Assets: Concealable Dagger, Dot Coder, Minimic Film (blank)

Anyone educated by the Bene Gesserit is a dangerous adversary, whether they're in rags or Imperial finery. Their training also gives them the charisma and confidence to manipulate an individual to their will or even influence a crowd.

Cloaked in mystery and appearing in every corner of the Imperium, Bene Gesserit agents gather information and further the schemes of the Order — all while the Sisterhood makes efforts to appear neutral in all political matters. These infiltrators are usually Sisters or acolytes, whose skills in heightened observation, prana-bindu conditioning, and mastery of the Voice makes them a boon to any venture.

Viewed by some as witches, the Sisterhood embraces this reputation. They use their supernatural mystique to strike fear in the hearts of men. But whether they are loved or hated, they have gained much by unearthing the secrets of others while obfuscating their true agenda and the extent of their true powers, keeping themselves shrouded in mystery.

EXAMPLE BENE GESSERIT AGENTS

- ☉ **Catriona**, a Bene Gesserit acolyte, is working to infiltrate the personal guard for one of the powerful merchants on Arrakis. The stark harshness of the desert planet appeals to her.
- ☉ **Peronel** is on Arrakis under the orders of the Reverend Mother Superior herself. They are to become a participant in a War of Assassins between two Houses. Their knowledge of poisons is unparalleled.
- ☉ **Elinor** is a cunning spy who has inserted herself into a Major House on behalf of the Sisterhood. But when spycraft fails her, she relies on her enchanting nature to beguile anyone who might suspect her ulterior motives.

SCENARIO HOOK

Representing a rival House, the Bene Gesserit Agent offers the player characters a diplomatic armistice. She provides a royal signet to back her claim and arranges a clandestine summit. Could this be an opportunity to put aside past differences and gain a powerful ally? Or is this a scheme to learn more about the player characters' plans?

BENE GESSERIT REVEREND MOTHER

DRIVE STATEMENT

DUTY:	6	
FAITH:	7	The Sisterhood will prevail.
JUSTICE:	5	
POWER:	5	
TRUTH:	6	

SKILL FOCUSES

BATTLE:	5	
COMMUNICATE:	6	
DISCIPLINE:	7	Command, Composure
MOVE:	5	
UNDERSTAND:	8	Faction Lore (Bene Gesserit)

Traits: Bene Gesserit, Reverend Mother

TALENTS

- ☞ **Hyperawareness:** Whenever she spends Threat to Obtain Information, she may know two pieces of information for each point spent. Further, the limits of what others would be able to notice does not apply.
- ☞ **Other Memory:** She may remember things from years before she was born through Other Memory.
- ☞ **Prana-Bindu Conditioning:** She may re-roll 1d20 on a Move or Discipline test.
- ☞ **Voice:** She may spend up to 3 points of Threat (1 Determination) to buy automatic successes on a Communicate test (1 success/point).

Assets: Dangerous Secret, Group of Bene Gesserit Acolytes, Robes of a Reverend Mother

Dignified, solemn, and powerful. With their robes swirling about them and their proud, knowing gazes, the Reverend Mothers of the Bene Gesserit Order are an imposing sight. These mighty women possess minds as sharp as a Mentat's and command their own bodies with an almost supernatural control. Only the truly reckless make an enemy of a Reverend Mother.

A Reverend Mother of the Bene Gesserit Sisterhood has survived the Agony, a ritual wherein the Sister ingests a fatal toxin (often the Water of Life) and alters her own body chemistry to neutralize its toxicity. The ordeal unlocks the Reverend Mother's access to the Other Memory of their ancestral bloodline, which may then be passed along genetically by another Reverend Mother. Other Memory provides them with the collective personalities and memories of previous Reverend Mothers, enhancing their considerable experience and wisdom.

Gifted with generational knowledge and the ability to detect lies and falsehoods, Reverend Mothers operate as counsellors and advisors. From their base of operations on Wallach IX, they manipulate the Landsraad in their search for the Kwisatz Haderach, a genetically engineered superhuman who will bring order to the galaxy.

EXAMPLE REVEREND MOTHERS

- ☞ **Axenus Arlana Avina** is a Truthsayer offering her services to help with the negotiations between two feuding Houses on Arrakis. Her intent is to tease out leverage the Sisterhood can use against both Houses.
- ☞ **Celestin Wilhelmina Sarraf** is an instructor from the Bene Gesserit Chapterhouse on Wallach IX. While some deride her as too much of a black sheep and others simply consider her eccentric, her ability to bring out the talents of others has made her indispensable.
- ☞ **Titus Leanne Naser** has a strong connection to her Other Memory. One particular Reverend Mother from the past is urging her to find a hidden cache of knowledge left somewhere on Arrakis.

SCENARIO HOOK

The Reverend Mother arrives unannounced at the House of the player characters, tasked by the governor of Arrakis with uncovering a plot against the Imperium. Each player character is subject to the Reverend Mother's interrogation, but is there something else at play here?

CRIMINAL

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY:

4

FAITH:

4

JUSTICE:

4

POWER:

7

I take what I need.

TRUTH:

4

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE:

6

Dirty Fighting,
Evasive Action

COMMUNICATE:

4

DISCIPLINE:

4

MOVE:

6

Stealth

UNDERSTAND:

4

Traits: Commoner, Lawless

TALENTS

- ☞ **Make Haste:** They may choose to suffer one additional complication in a Move test to gain one automatic success. During any conflict, they may spend 1 Threat to take the first action, regardless of who would otherwise act first.

Assets: Krimskel Fiber Rope, Maula Pistol, Small Gang

Wherever laws exist someone will attempt to profit by breaking them. Arrakis is no exception. Law enforcement away from the residencies of the noble Houses is minimal and pickpocketing, protection rackets, house-breaking, kidnapping, and even arson are rife.

EXAMPLE CRIMINALS

- ☞ **Dalon** operates a protection racket in the market. She knows every trader, and most fear her. She is well known by the criminal fraternity, including smugglers.

- ☞ **Tomlin** runs a pickpocketing and shoplifting racket. For a reasonable fee, Tomlin will arrange to obtain specific items from specific people.

- ☞ **Krat** likes to set fire to things. Sometimes he does this for pay and sometimes just for the pleasure of seeing things burn.

SCENARIO HOOK

An associate of the player characters comes home from the market without their wallet, which — apart from a small amount of currency — contained the key to a cypher the characters' House uses to communicate with an agent in an enemy House. Was this just a random act of theft or was the characters' friend targeted deliberately? If so, how did anyone know they were carrying the cypher key?



COURTIER

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY:

5

FAITH:

6

Arrakis needs the ruling class.

JUSTICE:

5

POWER:

7

TRUTH:

5

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE:

4

COMMUNICATE:

7

Charm, Gossip

DISCIPLINE:

6

Espionage

MOVE:

4

UNDERSTAND:

5

Traits: Courtier, Aristocrat

TALENTS

- ☞ **Mask of Power:** Once per scene they may create a temporary intrigue or espionage asset (at no cost) that will allow them to initiate an intrigue or espionage conflict. If they fail, the bluff is exposed, and they gain a complication.

Assets: Bodkin, Groundcar, Manor House

The Houses on Arrakis, like those throughout the Imperium, are always vying for power. So, too, are the courtiers. Many, but not all, are nobles. Heirs to Houses Minor and shipping fortunes are the types drawn to this world of intrigue. All have a stake in melange.

One can find courtiers at generous banquets where rumors fly faster than the sumptuous dishes can arrive at the table. As they sip rich wines with heady aromas and attend rowdy sporting competitions held inside out of the burning sun, the courtiers work to claw their way up

the social ladder, not caring who they trample beneath their heels in the process.

EXAMPLE COURTIER

- ☞ **Ramsay**, the heir to one of Arrakis' most influential Houses, believes their House should have a monopoly on all maintenance of the spice mining equipment on the planet. They have a deep love of listening to music from other planets.
- ☞ **Jivin's** mother is an incredibly wealthy and ruthless water seller from Carthag. And he wants to join the ranks of nobility – even if it means killing to get there. He has a fascination with other languages.
- ☞ **Orphe** intends to use her merchant family's riches to get revenge on the House Minor that killed her father. Her hobby is piloting ornithopters.

SCENARIO HOOK

To impress one of the Houses Minor, a courtier is looking to arrange a meeting with a representative from CHOAM. Their goal is to receive permission from the economic powerhouse to ship highly regulated and restricted goods onto Arrakis.



ENVOY

DRIVE STATEMENT

DUTY:

6

FAITH:

4

JUSTICE:

4

POWER:

4

TRUTH:

7

The message is what matters.

SKILL FOCUSES

BATTLE:

3

COMMUNICATE:

7

Charm, Diplomacy

DISCIPLINE:

5

MOVE:

5

UNDERSTAND:

6

Etiquette

Traits: Diplomat, Traveler

TALENTS

- ✧ **Binding Promise:** Spend 1, 2, or 3 points of Threat to make an agreement binding. To break it an opponent must spend twice this in Momentum.

Assets: Cypher Key, Elegant Clothing, Local Agents of their House

As it is quicker to send a messenger on a Guild ship than to try sending a signal between distant stars, envoys fulfill an essential function. They sometimes commit their messages to memory or are trusted to carry them securely on their journey. They have a great deal of flexibility in how to achieve the required outcome. Failure, for an envoy, is frequently fatal.

EXAMPLE ENVOYS

- ✧ **Tatil** is an envoy for a player character's House and has just returned from a failed mission. They desperately need to cover up their failure.
- ✧ **Lina** has come to a player character's House with a proposal that the head of the House is determined to reject.
- ✧ **Tanir** is an envoy from a friendly House from a distant planet, sent to negotiate with the Harkonnens. They are having trouble even getting an audience.

SCENARIO HOOK

A rival Espionage House sends an envoy. They propose your Houses join them in opposition to a powerful Military House with which your House is currently allied. Is this a genuine offer or will they back off after you have broken off the friendship and made a powerful enemy?

FACE DANCER

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY:

6

FAITH:

7

The universe is as inconstant as I am.

JUSTICE:

5

POWER:

5

TRUTH:

4

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE:

5

COMMUNICATE:

7

Acting, Disguise

DISCIPLINE:

5

MOVE:

6

Body Control

UNDERSTAND:

5

Traits: Imposter

TALENTS

- ☞ **Prana-Bindu:** May re-roll 1d20 on a Move or Discipline test.
- ☞ **Facedance:** They suffer no penalty to attempts to disguise their features, whether old or young, male or female, or as a specific person.

Assets: Face Dancers steal or copy the assets of the person they are mimicking, and frequently kill them to avoid exposure.

Some Face Dancers work as entertainers, which was their original purpose. Others, with their ability to mimic anyone, make supremely effective, if expensive, infiltrators. Many potential employers believe the Tleilaxu use the Face Dancers to further their own agenda, though none know the precise nature of that agenda.

EXAMPLE FACE DANCERS

- ☞ **Hakaar** is most skilled at infiltrating seedy places and currently works as an entertainer in an exotic bar. Their employment provides a deep vein of blackmail material.
- ☞ **Sarah** is adept at replacing specific people, often spending time getting close to a target as a friend or servant to study them before replacing them.
- ☞ **Torbyn** likes to work with machines and is a skilled pilot. They like to masquerade as an unobtrusive technician to access an enemy's technology.

SCENARIO HOOK

A Truthsayer told a close friend that the person they are about to marry is a Face Dancer. The friend wants to find out what happened to the 'original partner' the Face Dancer was imitating. Are they alive somewhere, or did the Face Dancer kill them? The Face Dancer insists they are the original partner and is genuinely upset by any accusations thrown at them.

FREMEN ELDER

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY:

5

FAITH:

7

Arrakis will be transformed.

JUSTICE:

6

POWER:

5

TRUTH:

5

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE:

7

Tactics, Short blades

COMMUNICATE:

4

DISCIPLINE:

8

Survival (Desert)

MOVE:

6

Worm Rider

UNDERSTAND:

5

Traits: Fremen

TALENTS

- ✧ **Binding Promise:** May spend 1, 2, or 3 points of Threat to make an agreement binding. To break it an opponent must spend twice this in Momentum.
- ✧ **Cautious (Discipline):** They may re-roll a single d20 gained from spending Threat.
- ✧ **Resilience (Battle):** They may Resist Defeat twice in a scene when in a conflict using the Battle skill.

Assets: Crysknife, Maker Hooks, Small Band of Fremen Warriors, Stillsuit

Rarely seen in the city, these mysterious elders prefer to stick to the deep desert. Long the victims of Harkonnen persecution, they are mistrustful of off-worlders and despise the pyons from Arrakeen. They are mines of information about the desert, its ways, and melange.

EXAMPLE FREMEN ELDERS

- ✧ **Akrab** is naib of his sietch, aging now and concerned that younger Fremen are building up their courage to challenge him.
- ✧ **Tefik** is the sibling of a naib but has never really found their place in the sietch. They take any opportunity to visit the city on sietch business wondering if they will find a place there.
- ✧ **Silandra** is weighed down with watercounters of former husbands and needs to prove that she still has a place in her sietch.

SCENARIO HOOK

Deep in the desert, a Fremen elder lies injured on the sand. She makes it clear she does not desire rescue. She asks only for the return of her water to her sietch. There is a rumbling in the distance, a sandworm is coming...



FREMEN WARRIOR

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY:

7

The sietch before all others.

FAITH:

8

JUSTICE:

6

POWER:

5

TRUTH:

5

"Who can turn away the Angel of Death? What Shai-Hulud has decreed must be." The Fedaykin, the Fremen death commandos, speak these words as they prepare for battle.

Just as the harsh conditions on Salusa Secundus produce the dreaded Sardaukar, the inhospitable landscape of Arrakis hones the Fremen into a terrifying force. Even the young know how to wield a knife and survive the deep desert. But those who claim the mantle of Fremen warrior are truly formidable, lethal on their own and devastating in large numbers.

With blue-within-blue eyes, a Fremen soldier wears a stillsuit and is equipped with a distinctive crysknife — a specialized dagger made from the tooth of a sandworm. They prefer the desert to the city and use the terrain to their advantage. This includes mounting sandworms to ride across the dunes. They're known to ambush their opponents with stealth and speed before vanishing without a trace.

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE:

8

Dueling, Short Blades, Unarmed combat

COMMUNICATE:

4

DISCIPLINE:

7

Survival (Desert), Resolve

MOVE:

7

Worm rider

UNDERSTAND:

5

Traits: Fremen

TALENTS

- ☞ **Decisive Action:** After successfully removing an enemy asset with Battle, remove a second enemy asset for 2 Threat.
- ☞ **Nimble:** When attempting a Move test over difficult terrain they may reduce the Difficulty of the test by 2. If this reduces the Difficulty to 0, they may move over or around that obstacle freely.
- ☞ **Resilience (Battle):** They may Resist Defeat twice in a scene when in a conflict using the Battle skill.

Assets: Crysknife, Fremkit, Stillsuit

EXAMPLE FREMEN WARRIORS

- ☞ **Fara** is the captain of a platoon of elite Fedaykin. Fanatical and intractable, she wages open war against her enemies (both real and perceived), even when her elders might prefer a more diplomatic approach.
- ☞ **Nasir** is an impatient, resentful Fremen warrior. After being passed over for promotion, he seeks to issue a tahaddi challenge against the Naib despite his family cautioning him against it.
- ☞ **Estes** is a veteran of many battles, all of which are beginning to take their toll. As age sets into their bones and muscles, they have little time left before becoming a burden. They would like to pass on their knowledge to a protégé before offering their water to the sietch.

SCENARIO HOOK

After the player characters find a rare and valuable crysknife during the excavation of a desert site, a trio of Fremen warriors confront them. They demand the blade be handed over to them for purification. However, the blade is incredibly valuable and deadly. The House could benefit immensely from its keeping. Do the player characters relent, or do they refuse?

GUILD AGENT

DRIVE STATEMENT

DUTY: **7** The spice must flow.

FAITH: **5**

JUSTICE: **4**

POWER: **5**

TRUTH: **6**

SKILL FOCUSES

BATTLE: **4**

COMMUNICATE: **6** Diplomacy

DISCIPLINE: **7** Composure, Self-Control

MOVE: **5**

UNDERSTAND: **5**

Traits: Guild Agent, Diplomat

TALENTS

☞ **Priority Boarding:** Avoid customs check on Guild vessels.

Assets: Guild Contacts, Shield Belt, Supply Contracts

Due to their inability to survive outside their tailored environment tanks, a Guild Navigator is a rare sight. The Guild does business through its agents who are easy to find anywhere a person might go to arrange interplanetary transport — for themselves, those they serve, or goods. Guild Agents are skilled at fitting in with their environment in manner and appearance. They pride themselves on being unremarkable and often hide their totally blue eyes.

EXAMPLE GUILD AGENTS

- ☞ **Senver** is a broker who will sell you passage on a Heighliner or arrange for transportation of your exports or imports but, mostly, Senver deals with smugglers.
- ☞ **Joh** is more likely to be at a dinner party or House entertainment than the Guild offices, but they arrange deals with Major Houses and act as an observer at high level meetings.
- ☞ **Rellis** is a mechanic who works on maintaining the sealed containers the Navigators need. She also sources supplies for the Guild office from the market.

SCENARIO HOOK

Someone identified as a spice smuggler is talking to a Guild Agent in the market. What deal do the Smugglers have with the Guild? Or do they have a deal at all? Might the consequence of looking into this too deeply be that the Guild refuses to work with your House?

HEALER

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY:

5

FAITH:

5

JUSTICE:

6

POWER:

5

TRUTH:

7

A harsh truth is superior to a kind lie.

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE:

4

COMMUNICATE:

5

DISCIPLINE:

6

Composure

MOVE:

6

UNDERSTAND:

7

Emergency Medicine, Surgery

Traits: Healer

TALENTS

- ☞ **Intense Study:** Once per scene, they may use their Understand skill on a single skill test instead of any other skill and are counted as having a focus for that test.

Assets: Glowglobe, Medical Records, Medkit

In a universe wrought with battles, duels, and various skirmishes in-between, healers are in high demand. Every noble House, Minor or Major, has at least one medical advisor who tends to the health of the family. Healers also find employment as medical technicians, surgeons, researchers, and advisors to planetary governors. From the combat medic assigned to the infantry to the country doctor who uses herbs to mend the sick, healers are pervasive throughout the Known Universe.

While many medical schools exist, none carry the prestige of the Suk School of Medicine. Identified by the diamond tattoo on their forehead, Suk graduates are the

most skilled healers in the Landsraad. Imperial conditioning ensures these doctors' loyalty and incorruptibility, making them incapable of taking another life, even under extreme duress. Suk doctors are also the most expensive, with a percentage of their fees tithed to the Suk School of Medicine on Kaitain.

EXAMPLE HEALERS

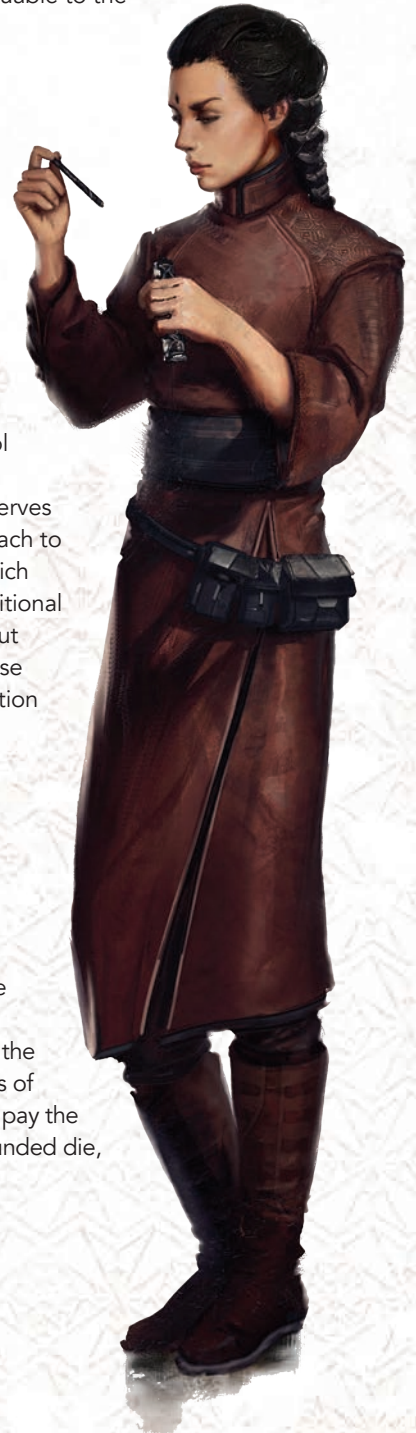
- ☞ **Roya** is an old medicine woman for Sietch Gara Kulon. Her bedside manner is sharper than a crysknife, and her knowledge of herbs, poisons, and toxins makes her invaluable to the Fremen.

- ☞ **Gallen** is a street surgeon operating from a private stall in Carthag. A dropout from a second-tier medical academy, he is addicted to semuta. However, he is also a viable option for someone in need of discreet medical services.

- ☞ **Shay** is a newly minted graduate of the Suk School of Medicine. Talented and often overconfident, she serves a Major House. Her approach to medicine is innovative, which clashes with the rigid, traditional Baron who employs her. But after curing a diabolical case of poison-induced indigestion during a tense summit, he complains less about her methods.

SCENARIO HOOK

After an ornithopter crashes in the middle of Arrakeen, the survivors rush the wounded to a local healer. Unfortunately, the healer, who is not a member of the Suk School, refuses to treat the injured unless they pay ten liters of water. Do the player characters pay the healer's steep price, let the wounded die, or find a third alternative?



HOUSE SOLDIER/GUARD

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY: **6** I never desert my post.

FAITH: **5**

JUSTICE: **4**

POWER: **4**

TRUTH: **4**

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE: **6** Lasgun, Tactics

COMMUNICATE: **4**

DISCIPLINE: **5** Composure

MOVE: **5**

UNDERSTAND: **4**

Traits: Military

TALENTS

- ☞ **Unquestionable Loyalty:** At the start of each adventure they are utilized in, they begin with 3 Threat (1 Determination) which only they may use, and which may only be used on an action which is in direct service to their House.

Assets: Conscripts, Lasgun, Security Clearance, Shield Belt

Every House needs soldiers and guards, brave men and women who ensure no intruders invade the residency and who stand in the front line of battle in times of war. Faithful and loyal though they are, they remain human and have weaknesses a wily enemy can exploit.

EXAMPLE HOUSE SOLDIERS/GUARDS

- ☞ **Finain** is loyal but has a sick mother in need of expensive medical treatment.

- ☞ **Zavir** has worked for the House since childhood and is honored to serve in a military capacity. Incorruptible.

- ☞ **Gideron** is loyal but gets distracted when worried about their wayward daughter.

SCENARIO HOOK

One of the House military has started to behave oddly. It emerges that her husband has gone missing, kidnapped by a rival House that is trying to subvert the loyal soldier by threatening those she loves.



MENTAT

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY:

6

FAITH:

5

JUSTICE:

5

POWER:

5

TRUTH:

7

There is always a reason.

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE:

5

COMMUNICATE:

6

Diplomacy

DISCIPLINE:

4

MOVE:

5

UNDERSTAND:

7

Data Analysis, Deductive Reasoning

Traits: Mentat, Political Advisor

TALENTS

- ☞ **Mentat Discipline:** Add two automatic successes on all Understand tests they attempt when remembering facts or data.

Assets: Access to Employer Data, Informant Network, Sapho Juice

Mentats undergo rigorous conditioning, turning themselves into human computers who are both moral and truthful. Bound by ethical constraints, Mentats are inherently honest, a conviction prized by the majority of the Landsraad. With their intense mental conditioning and exceptional cognitive ability, Mentats are employed by almost all influential entities within the Imperium, like Houses and high-volume traders. They are trusted as military strategists, administrators, political advisors, and tutors for young nobles. Many Mentats enhance their mental abilities by drinking Sapho juice, a liquid that stains their lips red.

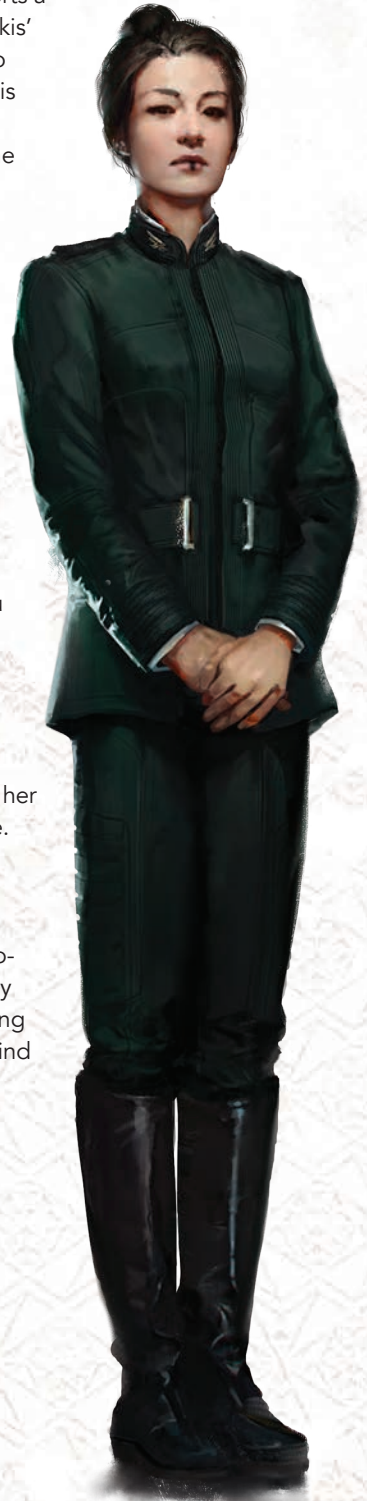
From economic strategy to military tactics, Mentats replaced computers and thinking machines generations ago. On the desert planet Arrakis, they help their employers consolidate power, gain more control over the melange trade, or outwit the competition. Rivalries are common, and so is pitting the brilliance of Mentats against each other.

EXAMPLE MENTATS

- ☞ **Oren Yudin** works for one of the merchants who imports a large percentage of Arrakis' technology. His goal is to create dependence on his merchant's goods, and a captive market, across the planet.
- ☞ **Nellis Entrekim** is the Mentat for a House Minor located on Arrakis. Their House has plans to absorb one of their rival Houses in their ambition to become a House Major of the Imperium.
- ☞ **Devin Vinal** has a position with the Tleilaxu representatives on Arrakis. As a Twisted Mentat, her specialty is to identify even the tiniest irregularities in accounting that will give her Tleilaxu masters an edge.

SCENARIO HOOK

For a hefty sum, a Mentat is seeking access to all the shipping records for Arrakis. They believe someone is stockpiling melange, and they want to find out who.



MERCHANT

DRIVE STATEMENT

DUTY:

5

FAITH:

5

JUSTICE:

6

POWER:

7

There is power in solaris.

TRUTH:

5

SKILL FOCUSES

BATTLE:

4

COMMUNICATE:

6

Bartering, Persuasion

DISCIPLINE:

4

MOVE:

4

UNDERSTAND:

5

Data Analysis

Traits: Broker, Wealthy

TALENTS

- ☞ **Driven:** After they spend Threat to gain a point of Determination, roll 1d20. If the roll is equal to or under their Discipline rating (by itself), they immediately regain that spent Threat.

Assets: Information Network, Ornithopter, Warehouse,

The swish of their exquisite clothing whispers of wealth. Expensive perfumes waft in their wake. They glide from place to place in their groundcars, avoiding the hot sun of Arrakis. With a tight stranglehold on legitimate trade, Arrakis' merchants handle most of the goods that enter the cities. From luxury imports to precious water, these cunning individuals work hard and will do almost anything, to make solaris on every transaction.

Many merchants, especially those with the fewest morals, are wealthy individuals with unsavory connections. Some deal with CHOAM, others with smugglers. Most act as brokers, buying and selling in bulk, and are rarely the ones braving the scorching sun to peddle their goods to the population. They leave that to the water sellers and small shop proprietors.

One area that the merchants can't seem to touch are the Fremen-manufactured wares, like their high quality stillsuits. That doesn't mean the merchants don't try, however.

EXAMPLE MERCHANTS

- ☞ **Flair** runs a hefty percentage of the water trade in Carthag and Arrakeen, taking advantage of her water sellers whenever she can. She treasures her vast collection of antique weapons.
- ☞ **Joash** primarily brokers imports with CHOAM and spends resources trying to crush the local smugglers. He has a weakness for adding exotic animals to his personal menagerie.
- ☞ **Druce** focuses their merchant empire on weapons and vehicles. They outfit many of the guards and soldiers of Arrakis' Houses Minor. Their passion is collecting fine wines.

SCENARIO HOOK

A merchant who claims to want to expand their business is looking for an introduction to a group of technology smugglers. But it's also possible that this merchant, instead, wants to identify and eliminate the smugglers who they see as competition.

NOBLE (YOUNG HEIR)

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY:

7

I am born to lead.

FAITH:

5

JUSTICE:

6

POWER:

5

TRUTH:

5

Despite their luxurious homes, unlimited access to water, and aristocratic experiences, the young nobles of the Imperium lead uncertain lives. From an early age they learn to identify a hunter-seeker and other methods of slaughter. Poison snoopers are common at the dinner table. The knowledge that a War of Assassination could happen at any moment makes the wisest of them wary and mistrustful.

Their banquets, games, and lavish spending may make them seem carefree. In fact, they are almost anything but. Political and social clashes, both overt and covert, rule their lives. If they survive to adulthood, they understand that they will become even more of a target.

Young nobles are always on the hunt for allies and looking to surprise their enemies in unexpected ways. And they always have solaris to help them get their way.

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE:

5

COMMUNICATE:

6

Diplomacy

DISCIPLINE:

7

Command, Composure

MOVE:

4

UNDERSTAND:

5

EXAMPLE YOUNG HEIR NOBLES

- ☉ **Bionbir** is learning to manage their family's water reclamation holdings on Arrakis. While they don't love the drudgery of their family's business, they feel a duty to follow in their House's footsteps.
- ☉ **Honora**, heiress to one of the Houses Minor, has a talent for codebreaking and counter-espionage. And she has plans to make her House into a major power within the Landsraad.
- ☉ **Belteshazzar** wants to escape Arrakis at any cost. He'll marry into another family. He'll give up his title. He'll become a smuggler. He'll join CHOAM or the Spacing Guild. He just never wants to see the Shield Wall or endless dunes again.

Traits: Noble, House Minor

TALENTS

- ☉ **Bold (Communicate):** May re-roll a d20 gained from spending Threat on a Communicate skill test.

Assets: Influence, Kindjal, Ornithopter

SCENARIO HOOK

Smugglers are eating into one House's bottom line, and the Landsraad is making noise about their weakness. The young heir is hiring mercenaries to put a stop to it. The smugglers, on the other hand, would love to get the jump on the ambitious noble.

NOBLE (VETERAN)

DRIVE STATEMENT

DUTY:

5

FAITH:

5

JUSTICE:

5

POWER:

7

Possession is nine tenths of the law.

TRUTH:

6

Not every young heir manages to survive the deadly games of politics. Those who do are deadly opponents, with the power of a noble House at their command. Many Houses both Major and Minor have representation on Arrakis, but an experienced noble needs some compelling reason to visit. Few come out of curiosity, more on business too secret to entrust to an envoy. Veteran nobles rarely travel alone; it would be dangerous for a prominent member of a noble House to do so.

EXAMPLE VETERAN NOBLES

- ✧ **Horace** is a respected noble of an Agricultural House, on Arrakis to strike a secret deal with the Harkonnens.
- ✧ **Slynn** is a cousin of the head of a rival House, on Arrakis to improve their standing by finding a new way to obtain spice.
- ✧ **Edvan**, a close relative of the head of a House Richese, is on Arrakis to avoid the manipulations of a rival within their House.

SKILL FOCUSES

BATTLE:

5

COMMUNICATE:

6

Diplomacy

DISCIPLINE:

6

MOVE:

5

UNDERSTAND:

7

House Politics, Kanly

SCENARIO HOOK

A veteran noble of an allied House seeks the assistance of the Atrides. They claim they have been the intended victim of chaumas, administered at a banquet in Carthag, and that they only escaped death because their bodyguard tasted the food before them. They want revenge. A Truthsayer reveals he is lying. Is he trying to escalate the rivalry between Harkonnen and Atrides?

Traits: Noble

TALENTS

- ✧ **Putting Theory into Practice:** Once per scene, when they Obtain Information, they may create a trait for free, representing an advantage they've identified with the information they received.

Assets: Bodyguards, Kindjal Engraved with House Crest, Shield Belt

SARDAUKAR (ELITE SOLDIER)

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY:

8

My knife is never sheathed.

FAITH:

5

JUSTICE:

5

POWER:

6

TRUTH:

5

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE:

8

Lasgun, Long Blades, Short Blades, Tactics

COMMUNICATE:

5

DISCIPLINE:

7

Self Control

MOVE:

7

Swift

UNDERSTAND:

4

Traits: Sardaukar, Soldier

TALENTS

- ☞ **Bolster:** Spend 2 Threat to allow an ally to re-roll their dice pool. The ally may use the Sardaukar's Discipline instead of their skill as well.
- ☞ **Decisive Action:** After successfully removing an enemy asset with Battle, they may remove a second enemy asset for 2 Threat.
- ☞ **Master-at-Arms:** At the start of a duel, skirmish, or battle, the Sardaukar may spend 1 point of Threat to increase a martial asset they have by +1 Quality for that conflict.

Assets: Sardaukar are equipped as according to their assignment, but generally carry a variety of concealed weapons including Lasgun, Shigawire Garrote, Shield, Kindjal, Flip-Dart, and more.

The Sardaukar are an elite military force, loyal only to the Padishah Emperor. They have a suicidal disregard for personal safety and a talent for brutality, due to their secret training on the prison world of Salusa Secundus. Only the most talented and resolute of warriors can face a Sardaukar with any hope of survival. Such is their reputation, even the suggestion they will be deployed by the Emperor is enough to bring a noble House to heel.

EXAMPLE SARDAUKAR

- ☞ **Lucan Savarese** is acting as a bodyguard and accompanying a member of House Corrino as they tour the Known Universe. His charge touched down on Arrakis mere days ago.
- ☞ **Valen** is a skilled warrior who fights on behalf of the Emperor at public Landsraad tournaments. Smug and arrogant, there are many fighters who would like to see him cut down.
- ☞ **Channing Hudgeons** has a swift sword and swifter temper. They arrived on Arrakis embedded in the troops of one of the Great Houses that has plans to rule the planet one day. They'll make sure to put an end to those ambitions.

SCENARIO HOOK

The player characters need vital information from a stubborn noble, and a Sardaukar bodyguard is acting as an impassable gatekeeper. Do the player characters take the Sardaukar head on, attempt to bribe him, or find an alternative means of eliminating the imposing figure from the equation?



SCIENTIST

DRIVE STATEMENT

DUTY:

5

FAITH:

5

JUSTICE:

5

POWER:

4

TRUTH:

7

Science will solve the problem.

SKILL FOCUSES

BATTLE:

3

COMMUNICATE:

4

DISCIPLINE:

6

Observe

MOVE:

4

UNDERSTAND:

7

Deductive Reasoning, Physics

Traits: Researcher

TALENTS

- ☉ **Intense Study:** Once per scene, they may use their Understand skill on a single skill test instead of any other skill, and they are counted as having a focus for that test.

Assets: Shigawire Reels, Laboratory, Data About Arrakis

One can find scientists all over the Imperium. Some handle caustic chemicals under ventilation hoods, while others are smeared in grease from tinkering on the latest carryall design. From designing ships that travel the stars to concocting poisons from local flora, these brilliant researchers change the way the Imperium functions.

On Arrakis, several Houses have secret laboratories dedicated to trying to create an artificial source of the spice melange. Other groups are trying to find a way to increase the efficiency of harvested spice. Some Houses are searching for melange's origins and a way to farm it from the planet reliably. And then there are those entities searching

for new weapons and ways to destroy their competition. Scientific research supports them all.

Scientists do not often participate in political games. However, they can become pawns. Depending on their expertise, kidnapping or assassination is a very real possibility.

EXAMPLE SCIENTISTS

- ☉ **Talaith Ng** always has a wrench in one hand and the sharp smell of oil about her. She is working with one of the Houses on creating hardier ornithopters that can withstand Arrakis' famous coriolis storms.

- ☉ **Izel Antaya** works out of one of the hidden smugglers' bases deep in the desert. In exchange for helping the smugglers cobble together whatever medication and tools they need, they are also working to understand the sparse plant and animal life on Arrakis.

- ☉ **Windham Jalloh** isn't officially on Arrakis at all but smuggled in by one of the local merchants who wants him to find a way to distill spice out of the planet's very air — on pain of death, of course.

SCENARIO HOOK

A less-than-ethical scientist wants their competitor's data. They're offering a pretty payday for anyone who breaks into the lab, steals the data, and sabotages all the ongoing experiments.



SERVANT

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY:

4

FAITH:

4

JUSTICE:

4

POWER:

5

TRUTH:

6

What one wishes were true is seldom so.

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE:

3

COMMUNICATE:

5

Listening

DISCIPLINE:

6

MOVE:

6

Unobtrusive

UNDERSTAND:

4

Etiquette

Traits: Servant

TALENTS

- ☞ **Nimble:** When attempting a Move test over difficult terrain they may reduce the Difficulty of the test by 2. If this reduces the Difficulty to 0, they may move over or around that obstacle freely.

Assets: Illicit Recordings, Old Friendship, Trusted Access

With quiet footsteps, House servants go about their business, often unnoticed by those they serve. Though the nobles may pay them little mind, domestic attendants are observant, perceptive, and more powerful than the Houses could imagine. They see and hear scandals that could destroy reputations within the Landsraad. They know secrets that could turn to blackmail. In subtle ways and with understated suggestions, they can manipulate their employers into taking actions without their nobles ever being the wiser.

Servants handle the day-to-day operations of a noble House, functioning as assistants, couriers, cooks, gardeners, guards, maids, mechanics, secretaries, and tutors. Servants tend to be close-knit within a given House with a shared responsibility for the success of the nobles. Many servants on Arrakis also have outside loyalties. Some are powerful Fremen and are influential within their communities and their sietches. Others have connections to spies or smugglers or assassins.

EXAMPLE SERVANTS

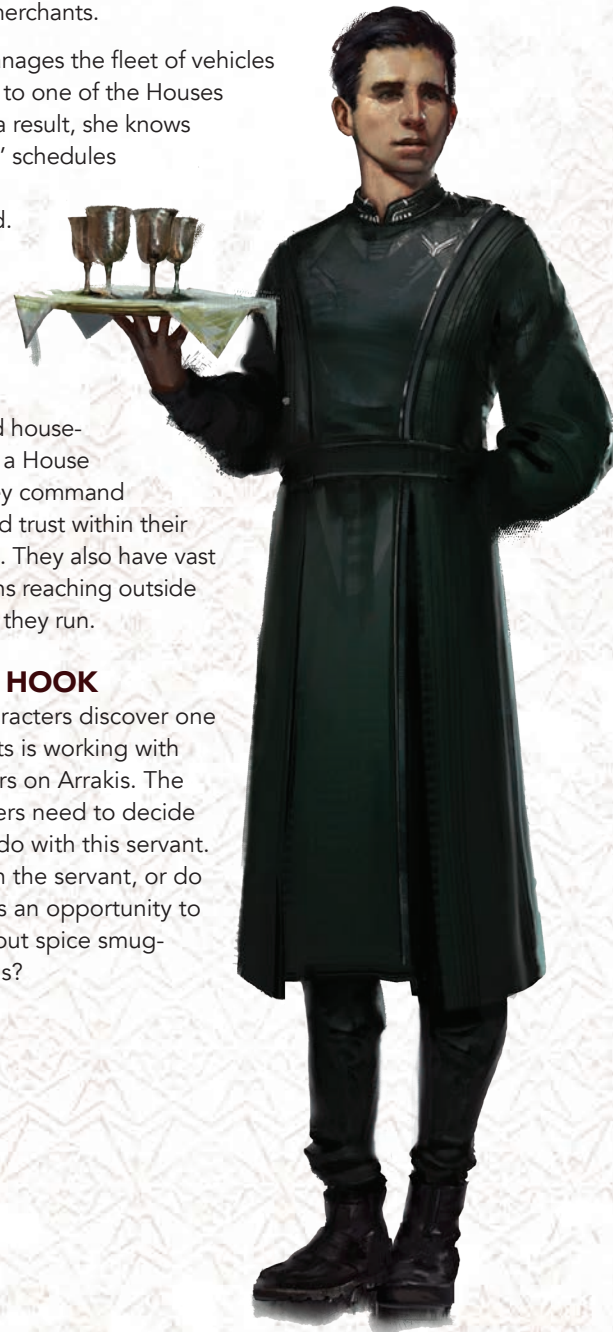
- ☞ **Trophnus** works as a cook for one of the Houses Minor on Arrakis. He knows the preferences, and deadly allergies, of every one of the nobles in his House. He also has family ties to one of the local merchants.

- ☞ **Noemi** manages the fleet of vehicles belonging to one of the Houses Minor. As a result, she knows her nobles' schedules down to the second. She is the daughter of a naib.

- ☞ **Rheged** is the head house-keeper for a House Minor. They command respect and trust within their household. They also have vast connections reaching outside the House they run.

SCENARIO HOOK

The player characters discover one of their servants is working with spice smugglers on Arrakis. The player characters need to decide what they will do with this servant. Do they punish the servant, or do they use this as an opportunity to learn more about spice smuggling on Arrakis?



SMUGGLER

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY:

5

FAITH:

5

JUSTICE:

7

They will not control us.

POWER:

6

TRUTH:

5

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE:

5

Dirty Fighting

COMMUNICATE:

4

DISCIPLINE:

3

MOVE:

6

Drive, Stealth

UNDERSTAND:

5

Traits: Smuggler

TALENTS

- ☉ **Constantly Watching:** Whenever they attempt a test to detect danger or hidden enemies, they reduce the Difficulty by 2, to a minimum of 0. In addition, once per scene, they can increase the cost for another to Keep the Initiative by +2.

Assets: Hidden Base, Maula Pistol, Ornithopter

Ornithopters hum between bases deep in the deserts of Arrakis, while space-worthy vessels laden with contraband climb into near orbit around the planet. Smugglers supply illegally acquired spice that leaves no record of its existence to anyone who can pay.

They chafe under the power structures of the Imperium, like the abuses suffered at the hands of the ruling House of Arrakis and the tyranny of CHOAM. The smugglers of this world will do anything they can to undermine it.

But living outside the law on a planet as unforgiving as Arrakis isn't for the faint of heart. There is the constant risk of discovery and death at the hands of the Landsraad, CHOAM, and the sands. These rebels make it work by keeping their wits about them and possessing a fierce determination to survive. Though they may seem like a ragtag bunch, Arrakis' smugglers are clever, motivated, and driven.

EXAMPLE SMUGGLERS

- ☉ **Terris Ghurani** coordinates the movements and sales for one of the largest smuggling rings on Arrakis. They tend to stay in a ship in near orbit, watching for any movements from their foes and shifting their plans accordingly.
- ☉ **Maelee Lyng** is first into the fight whenever her smuggling group comes up against House soldiers or CHOAM law enforcement. She's quick with a knife and a garrote.
- ☉ **Abdalmujib Hake** pilots one of the ornithopters for smuggler grab-and-go operations. He has a sharp eye for untouched spice fields. The rumor is that he was once a noble himself.

SCENARIO HOOK

Someone is planning to betray one of the smuggling rings on Arrakis. The smugglers will pay for the informant — dead or alive. The betrayer, on the other hand, is willing to part with their solaris for protection.

